

the Line In of the sound card. If it has Audio In, connect the Audio Out of player to it; connect the Composite Out of the video player to the Composite In of the tuner. Now, using a small male-male stereo cable, connect the Audio Out of the tuner card to the Mic In of the sound card.

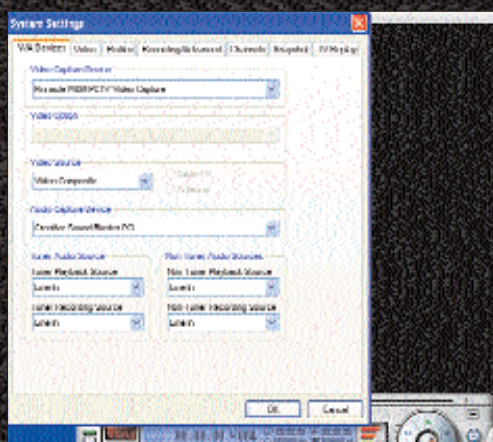
6 Now that you've installed the hardware and drivers, you're ready to install the capture software—we used PowerVCR. When installing PowerVCR, you're asked to specify a program directory and a working directory where all the recorded video will be stored. You are also asked whether you want to back up your system files, or just install the software; choose to back up the files, as this will help you revert to your system's previous state if you want to uninstall the software. All the necessary codecs are also installed. Restart the machine once you're done installing.

7 The very first thing you have to do is configure the channels. As soon as you start the software, you're asked to do this. The lazy way out is to press the Auto Scan option, and let the software set the channels automatically. You will, however, need to fine-tune a bit here and there to get optimum picture and sound quality. You can also spend a little time naming the channels, but remember that these names are stored in the software. So, if your cable operator changes the fre-

quencies of the channels, you're going to have wrongly labelled channels—a predicament that we all endure with TVs, when our favourite channel is changed from the easily accessible channel number 1 to number 104.

8 Now you need to configure some of the other parameters depending upon your needs. Click on the button with the nail and hammer image—you will see a list of tabs, each showing a list of parameters to be configured.

The first tab is V/A devices, where you can set the proper Video/Audio parameters such as video capture device, audio capture device, video source, audio source, etc. In this case, the video and audio capture devices are the TV tuner card itself. If your



Selecting the video and audio device, as well as the video and audio input, is critical to proper viewing and recording

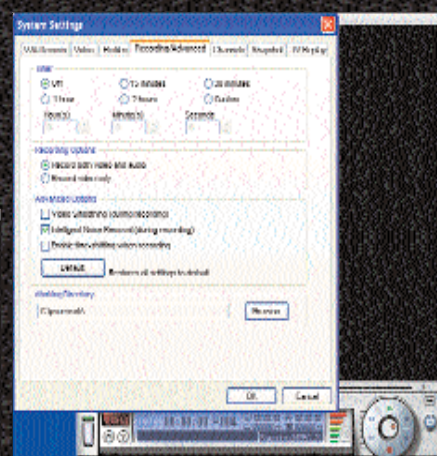
TV tuner card does not have Audio In, remember that the audio capture device has to be set as your sound card.

You also need to specify the signal source as TV, S-Video, or Composite. This will be TV mostly, and when you want to connect a video player, change this to Composite or S-Video. You also need to set the Audio Input to Mic In.

9 In the Video tab, set the actual video adjustment options such as brightness, hue, contrast, sharpness and saturation.

10 The software supports profiles for capture formats, so this step involves selecting the appropriate one in the Profiles tab. You have a wide variety to choose from—PAL, NTSC, MPEG-1, MPEG-2, etc.

11 The next tab deals with configuring the default options that you need for



If you find that the video-quality is poor, tweak the advanced options. Observe what each change does to the video in order to get the perfect setting

recording, say, the time, and some advance options such as Noise Removal, Video Smoothing, etc.

12 In the Snapshot tab, specify which folder to save the snapshot images you take. The last tab, TV Replay, lets you configure the Replay Buffer Time Limit that decides how much the software caches to show you when you demand an Instant Replay.

Draw the curtains, hang the 'Don't Disturb' sign on the door, put up your feet and tune into your favourite show.

Once you're done connecting everything, it should look like the figure on the left.

- 1 Composite Out (TV) connects to Composite In (TV Tuner).
- 2 Audio Out (TV) connects to Audio In (TV Tuner).
- 3 Audio Out (TV Tuner) connects to Audio In (soundcard).
- 4 Audio Out (soundcard) connects to the speakers.

PowerVCR III

